

Search Engine Optimization (SEO) has come a long way since its birth, when the best way to optimise your website was to be the owner of the website that shouted the loudest. In its formative years, SEO had an “anything goes” feel about it, with spammy backlinking, going overboard with keywords, and often a grossly excessive amount of tags. Slower development cycles meant that it took several months for search engines to rollout updates to their search algorithms, and this meant that imperfect practices lasted much longer back then. Between the years 2000 and 2002, Google implemented just 2 updates to their Search Engine. In comparison, Google had 5 updates in 2015 alone, and has already rolled out 4 updates in 2016.

Search engines like Exact revolutionized search engines by cataloguing information back in 1993. Then came Yahoo and Google. They took it upon themselves to better index and optimise search results, and they succeeded. One of them, of course, did so in spectacular fashion and went on to become a truly global phenomenon that is arguably changing the world harder and faster than any other company in the world.

Here are the most common misconceptions in the world of SEO.

1) SEO techniques are frauds, and they don't work

No. Slow down. SEO is a legitimate way to increase the visibility of your website. The key is to avoid all “black-hat” practices -- cheap tricks that make you the bad guy on the Internet. And everyone hates a bad guy on the Internet.

The reason for this myth is the existence of innumerable companies that are devoted to scamming websites with false promises using a ‘Pre-packaged SEO solution’. Back in the infancy of the Internet, it was possible to see long term results by “blasting” links pointing your website to thousands of others. Nowadays such practices are not just avoided, but aggressively penalized – Google might permanently stop your website from appearing in their search results, even if the query is full of keywords associated with your website. Beware also of services that promise manual submissions, and “guaranteed” number one ranking.

Instead, it's a good idea to do your research, and if you do want to purchase a service that does SEO, check to see if they are legitimate. If you don't hire a service, SEO is a simple enough thing to do if you follow the right habits -- value quality over quantity, promote your site using the plethora of social media available, and contribute to sites relevant to your subject